

Answer Key: Sleep, Stress and Mental Health Worksheet

Teacher's copy — do not distribute to students

Section	Tasks	Marks	Notes
Part A — Comprehension	A1, A2, A3	20 marks	1 mark per correct answer
Part B — Vocabulary	B1, B2	20 marks	1 mark per correct answer
TOTAL		40 marks	

PART A — COMPREHENSION ANSWERS

Task A1 — True / False / Not Given [7 marks]

Accept only TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN (or T / F / NG). No partial marks.

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| 1. | FALSE | Article says sleep and stress management are 'just as important' — not more important. |
| 2. | TRUE | Part One: 'your brain processes and stores information ... your body repairs damaged cells.' |
| 3. | TRUE | Part One: 'The sleep cycle lasts approximately 90 minutes and repeats several times each night.' |
| 4. | FALSE | Part Two: 'Not all stress is bad. Short-term stress ... is a normal and healthy biological response.' |
| 5. | TRUE | Part Two: 'Chronic stress keeps cortisol levels permanently elevated, which has deeply damaging effects.' |
| 6. | FALSE | Part Three: 'Resilience is not something you either have or do not have. It is a skill that can be built.' |
| 7. | TRUE | Part Three: 'even ten minutes of focused breathing per day has been shown to produce measurable benefits.' |

Task A2 — Note Completion [9 marks — one word only]

Accept only the exact word from the article. Do not accept synonyms unless noted.

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| 8. | deep | Part One: 'light sleep, deep sleep, and a phase called REM.' |
| 9. | cortisol | Part One: 'raises cortisol levels, the body's primary stress hormone.' |
| 10. | melatonin | Part One: 'The hormone melatonin, produced by the brain in darkness.' |

11.	production	Part One: 'exposure to bright screens before bed suppresses its production.'
12.	response	Part Two: 'a normal and healthy biological response.'
13.	cortisol	Part Two: 'Chronic stress keeps cortisol levels permanently elevated.' Accept: cortisol levels.
14.	exhaustion	Part Two: 'a state of complete physical and emotional exhaustion.'
15.	recover	Part Three: 'the ability to recover from setbacks.'
16.	mindfulness	Part Three: 'the practice of deliberately paying attention to the present moment.'

Task A3 — Short Answer Questions [4 marks — 1 mark each]

Award 1 mark for any answer that clearly conveys the key idea in the student's own words. Do not penalise grammar errors if meaning is clear.

17.	Short-term stress is a healthy biological response that sharpens focus and increases energy before a challenging situation.	Key idea: short-term / temporary stress is normal and useful — it helps performance under pressure.
18.	Chronic stress keeps cortisol permanently high, damaging the immune system, raising blood pressure, disrupting sleep, and increasing risk of depression and burnout.	Key idea: any two or three effects listed. Must include the word 'chronic' or equivalent.
19.	They form a self-reinforcing cycle: stress makes sleep harder, poor sleep raises cortisol, and both increase risk of anxiety and depression, which then make stress and sleep worse.	Key idea: circular/cyclical relationship — stress → poor sleep → worse mental health → more stress.
20.	No — it is an active state of wellbeing in which a person can cope with stress, work productively, and contribute to their community.	Key idea: mental health is positive and active, not just the absence of illness.

Task B1 — Vocabulary Matching [8 marks]

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| 1. | d — sleep deprivation | <i>Getting significantly less sleep than the body needs.</i> |
| 2. | e — cortisol | <i>The body's primary stress hormone, raised by poor sleep and pressure.</i> |
| 3. | g — melatonin | <i>A hormone produced in darkness that regulates the sleep cycle.</i> |
| 4. | f — chronic stress | <i>Stress that is constant and long-term, never fully resolved.</i> |
| 5. | a — resilience | <i>The ability to recover from setbacks and adapt to difficult situations.</i> |
| 6. | h — cognitive function | <i>Mental processes such as thinking, memory, and decision-making.</i> |
| 7. | b — burnout | <i>A state of exhaustion from long-term overwork, with slow recovery.</i> |
| 8. | c — mindfulness | <i>The practice of paying full attention to the present moment without judgement.</i> |

Task B2 — Gap-Fill [12 marks — 1 mark per gap]

Award 1 mark per blank filled correctly. Sentences 9, 10, 12, 13, 15, 17 require 2–3 answers — mark each blank independently.

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| 9. | sleep cycle / deep sleep | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. |
| 10. | cortisol / anxiety | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: anxiety OR depression for second blank. |
| 11. | melatonin / insomnia | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: sleep deprivation for second blank. |
| 12. | chronic stress / depression / burnout | 3 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept any order for second and third blanks. |
| 13. | cortisol / blood pressure | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: fatigue for second blank. |
| 14. | burnout | 1 blank. |
| 15. | sleep hygiene / wellbeing | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: cognitive function OR fatigue for second blank. |
| 16. | mental health / self-care | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: wellbeing for second blank. |
| 17. | mindfulness / resilience / wellbeing | 3 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: cognitive function OR mental health for third blank. |

MARKING SUMMARY

A1 (T/F/NG): 7 marks · A2 (Note completion): 9 marks · A3 (Short answer): 4 marks · B1 (Matching): 8 marks · B2 (Gap-fill): 12 marks · TOTAL: 40 marks